Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠5

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠10

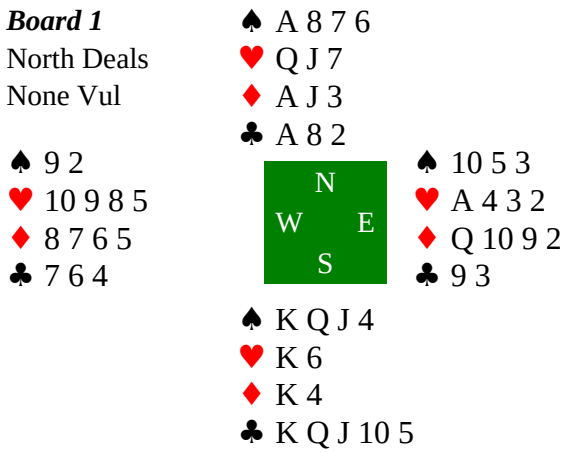
Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♦
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣7

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♠5

When NORTH opens 1NT SOUTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3	
♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K
	♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]	Pass
6♥[4]	Pass	7NT	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by East
Lead: ♠Q

EAST has a pretty good hand, and when WEST shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding WEST with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 7 ♥ K 9 ♦ A Q J 10 4 ♣ A Q J 7	
♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ Q 8 5 3 ♦ 9 8 2 ♣ 5 4		♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ J 7 6 2 ♦ 6 3 ♣ 10 9 3
	♠ A 6 2 ♥ A 10 4 ♦ K 7 5 ♣ K 8 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ 2 ♣ 7 5	
♠ 6 ♥ K 4 ♦ K J 9 7 4 ♣ A Q J 9 2	N W E S	♠ A K 5 ♥ 7 ♦ Q 10 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 8 4
	♠ Q 10 9 7 2 ♥ A Q J 6 ♦ A 8 ♣ 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	3♦	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by West
Lead: ♣7

WEST thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 4
♥ K Q 10 9 5
♦ A 7 6
♣ A 5 4

♠ 8 5 2
♥ 4 3
♦ K J 10 2
♣ J 9 6 3



♠ 10 9 6
♥ 7 2
♦ Q 9 8 4
♣ K Q 10 2

♠ A Q J 7 3
♥ A J 8 6
♦ 5 3
♣ 8 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

NORTH knows SOUTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, SOUTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces NORTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.